

MAJID MUMTAZ, CIA, ACA, FCCA

INTERNAL AUDIT & GRC EXECUTIVE | AUDIT COMMITTEE SECRETARY

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Professional Summary

Strategic Chief Audit Executive (CAE) with 20+ years of experience driving audit transformation, pre-IPO SOX/ICFR readiness, and Board-level governance. Proven track record of building audit functions from scratch, designing internal control frameworks, achieving zero material weaknesses, and delivering AED 7.7M+ in commercial recoveries through data analytics and continuous auditing. Expert in navigating GCC regulatory landscapes (CMA, RERA, PDPL, GDPR) and driving executive stakeholder alignment across the C-suite and Board.

Core Competencies

- **Governance & Risk:** Enterprise Risk Management (ERM), Risk Appetite Framework (including Risk Appetite Statements), Board & Audit Committee Reporting, Sarbanes-Oxley (SOX) Compliance, Internal Control Framework Design, Internal Control over Financial Reporting (ICFR), COSO Framework, Quality Assurance & Improvement Program (QAIP), Segregation of Duties (SoD), Audit Committee Charter, Internal Audit Charter, Tone at the Top, Corporate Governance, Regulatory Compliance, Compliance Frameworks, Regulatory Risk, Compliance Monitoring (CMA, RERA, UAE PDPL, GDPR).
- **Audit Methodology:** Risk-Based Audit Planning, Annual Audit Plan Design, Continuous Auditing, Continuous Monitoring, Fraud Investigation, Root Cause Analysis, Process Mapping, Third-Party Risk Management (TPRM), Control Self-Assessment (CSA), Integrated Auditing, Risk and Control Matrices (RCMs), Process Walkthroughs, Tests of Design (TOD), Tests of Operating Effectiveness (TOE), Key Control Identification (Entity-Level & Process-Level Controls), Control Deficiency Assessment, Material Weakness & Significant Deficiency Remediation, Audit Universe Definition.
- **Technology & GRC Systems:** Python (Pandas) Data Analytics, Information Technology General Controls (ITGC), Cloud Governance, Cybersecurity Assurance, Vulnerability Assessment, SAP & Oracle ERP Auditing, NAVEX Ethics-Point Whistleblower Hotline, Business Continuity / Disaster Recovery (BC/DR), Data Governance, Data Privacy, Machine Learning Applications.
- **Leadership & Management:** Team Leadership & Mentoring, Talent Management, Talent Development, Succession Planning, Resource Management, Budget Management, Executive Stakeholder Alignment, Audit Committee Secretary, Board Reporting, Pre-IPO Readiness, External Audit Coordination.

Professional Experience

Veritux Consulting Network

Principal, Internal Audit & Risk Advisory (Fractional CAE Services)

Dubai, UAE
Jul 2025 – Present

- **Fractional CAE Oversight:** Providing fractional CAE and advisory services to GCC mid-market firms during IPO readiness, corporate restructuring, and regulatory transformation.
- **Board-Level Strategic Advisory:** Provided strategic risk and governance advisory to GCC operators, driving Enterprise Risk Assessments and corporate governance maturity; constructed the Internal Audit Charter and Audit Committee Charter for a Saudi family office to satisfy Saudi Capital Market Authority (CMA) regulations.
- **Governance Frameworks:** Revised Internal Audit Charters, defined Audit Universes, and implemented Segregation of Duties (SoD) matrices for mid-market GCC clients to align with IIA Standards.
- **CapEx/OpEx Forensic Auditing:** Deployed an ML risk engine to monitor a SAR 500M+ project portfolio for a KSA real estate developer; identified procurement and payment anomalies that recovered SAR 3.2M annually through Data Analytics.
- **RERA Compliance:** Designed and implemented a risk-based internal audit framework for a UAE property developer, reducing exposure to regulatory enforcement.

Kitopi

Director of Internal Audit & GRC | Audit Committee Secretary

Dubai, UAE
Jun 2022 – May 2025

- **Pre-IPO SOX Compliance:** Held full Chief Audit Executive (CAE) functional accountability; designed and implemented the pre-IPO SOX/ICFR program, establishing a formal Risk Assessment Methodology to define the Audit Universe, and applying the COSO 2013 Framework to design and test Risk and Control Matrices (RCMs) through process walkthroughs, ensuring zero material weaknesses during EY's readiness attestation.
- **Audit Committee Governance:** Managed the Audit Committee's governance machinery (agendas, Board pack distribution, and minutes for 12+ annual sessions); presented control remediation updates, and coordinated with the C-suite on Audit Committee directives; deployed NAVEX EthicsPoint as the independent whistleblower hotline.
- **Stakeholder Management & Tone at the Top:** Served as the primary liaison between the Audit Committee and external auditors (EY, KPMG), managing all coordination and audit fee reviews; independently presented control deficiency remediation plans to the Board, reinforcing the control environment and Tone at the Top on risk culture.
- **Data Analytics & Continuous Auditing:** Built a Python/Pandas population testing engine ("Audit Intelligence Platform") approved by the Board for group-wide deployment, recovering AED 3.2M in vendor overcharges and neutralizing AED 4.5M in forward exposure (AED 7.7M total commercial recovery).
- **Board Reporting & Dashboards:** Developed quarterly Audit Committee dashboards and control deficiency heat maps summarizing emerging risk trend analysis and control remediation status.
- **Governance & Risk Appetite:** Partnered with the Board and C-suite to operationalize the Group's Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) framework and Risk Appetite Framework.
- **Fraud Mitigation:** Reduced fraud losses by 78% (saving AED 1.2M annually) through automated continuous monitoring and anomaly detection, applying Root Cause Analysis to systemic control failures.
- **Cybersecurity & ITGC:** Led the design and implementation of the ITGC framework, including formal audit programs for Logical Access, Change Management, and Computer Operations, and directed group-wide Cybersecurity and Data Privacy Audits (aligning with UAE PDPL and GDPR), mitigating data leak vulnerabilities.
- **Function Scaling:** Scaled the internal audit and IT security assurance team from inception to support the IPO program (3 auditors, 2 IT security professionals).

Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC)

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk | Audit Committee Secretary

Riyadh, KSA

Nov 2016 – May 2022

- **Governance Excellence:** Achieved the IIA's top 'Generally Conforms' rating on the Quality Assurance & Improvement Program (QAIP), including External Quality Assessment (EQA), confirming strict adherence to global IIA Standards across methodology and governance.
- **ERM & Annual Planning:** Designed a Board-commissioned risk framework across a four-sector conglomerate; drafted and presented the annual risk-based Internal Audit Plan to the Board, securing 100% approval and 96% completion rate.
- **Enterprise Risk Management (ERM):** Implemented COSO-aligned Enterprise Risk Assessments covering inherent and residual risks against the Board's stated risk appetite across a four-sector conglomerate; consolidated Group-wide risk exposure to inform an insurance strategy overhaul that reduced premiums by 15%.
- **M&A Due Diligence:** Led due diligence on a USD 127M acquisition, uncovering SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure; findings directly influenced deal renegotiations prior to closing.
- **Risk Monitoring & KPIs:** Reduced fraud losses by 82% and saved SAR 4.2M annually; designed and operationalized a Key Risk Indicators (KRIs) dashboard and established department KPIs, maintaining a 95% management action closure rate and 96% audit plan completion rate.
- **Resilience & BC/DR Audits:** Directed comprehensive reviews of Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery (BC/DR) plans across all sectors, strengthening conglomerate operational resilience.
- **Charter Governance:** Reviewed and updated the Internal Audit Charter and Audit Committee Charter annually to align holding and subsidiary frameworks with evolving IIA Standards.
- **Resource & Budget Management:** Directed strategic Resource Management and Budget Management for the group co-sourced audit budget of USD 450K, including co-sourcing cybersecurity audits with PwC and KPMG.
- **Team Leadership & Mentoring:** Scaled the audit team from 3 to 20 professionals, mentoring and coaching team members in data analytics and forensic methodologies.
- **Dual Mandate Role:** Co-opted as Audit Committee Member for the Restaurant Sector (Feb 2021 – May 2022) to govern restructuring operations.

McDonald's Saudi Arabia

Manager, Internal Audit (Function Lead)

Riyadh, KSA

Mar 2014 – Oct 2016

- **Operational Audit & Process Improvement:** Spearheaded a comprehensive operational audit, business process re-engineering, and process improvement initiative, utilizing Root Cause Analysis to drive a step-change in team productivity (from 30% to 70% of planned audit hours per engagement) within one year, increasing overall audit coverage by 25%.
- **Enterprise Risk Assessment:** Pioneered the implementation of a risk-based internal audit methodology, shifting the

function from a compliance-centric model to a strategic, enterprise-wide risk assessment approach.

- **Corporate Governance & Third-Party Risk:** Established robust corporate governance protocols and coordinated third-party risk assessments directly with McDonald's Middle East Development Corporation (MEDC) and McDonald's Global Corp.

KPMG (Qatar) – *Internal Audit Manager*

Apr 2011 – Dec 2013

BMA Asset Management (Karachi, Pakistan) – *AVP, Internal Audit*

Mar 2010 – Apr 2011

Ernst & Young (Karachi, Pakistan) – *Audit Manager*

Dec 2004 – Oct 2009

Certifications

- **CIA** (Certified Internal Auditor) — Institute of Internal Auditors (IIA), USA
- **ACA** (Associate Chartered Accountant) — Institute of Chartered Accountants of Pakistan (ICAP)
- **FCCA** (Fellow Chartered Certified Accountant) — Association of Chartered Certified Accountants, UK
- **GRCP & GRCA** (GRC Professional & GRC Auditor) — OCEG (Open Compliance & Ethics Group)
- **Disruptive Strategy** — Harvard Business School (HBS) Online
- **COSO ERM Certificate** — Institute of Internal Auditors (IIA) / COSO
- **Risk Management Specialization** — New York Institute of Finance (NYIF)
- **Forensic Accounting & Fraud Examination** — West Virginia University (WVU)
- **Machine Learning with Python** — IBM Professional Certificate

Education

- **UK ENIC Evaluation:** ACCA membership evaluated as equivalent to a UK Master's Degree
- **Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com):** Karachi University, Pakistan

Publications

- **GRC Report:** The CFO Is the Audit Independence Risk You're Not Managing
- **CCI:** FCPA Programs Are Missing Important Nuances About How Bribery Works...
- **ACCA AB Magazine:** Keeping Risk Registers Relevant
- **GRC Report:** AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability
- **IIA Magazine:** Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags
- **Consultancy ME:** The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy...